

# difference between printf and println in java? [duplicate]

Asked 9 years, 10 months ago   Modified 9 years, 10 months ago   Viewed 34k times



8



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[Is there a good reason to use "printf" instead of "print" in java?](#) (4 answers)

Closed 9 years ago.

Just came to know that `java` does has a method named `printf`, then what is the difference between `printf` & `println`?

`java` `printf` `println`

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asked Feb 27, 2015 at 6:08



**Bhargav Modi**

2,645 ● 3 ● 32 ● 50

`printf` is like the C `printf` function, "print format", the other is a more (or less) updated version, which doesn't require a format and value list...What does the JavaDoc's tell you? – [MadProgrammer](#) Feb 27, 2015 at 6:10

@MadProgrammer than what is the use of it if we have `format` and `printf` the same? – [Bhargav Modi](#) Feb 27, 2015 at 6:12

Because for many, `printf` is confusing and be difficult to use if you've not used it before. You can use `println("Say " + word)` or `printf("Say %s\n", word)`, which one is generally more easier to read? C doesn't have a `String` in the sense that Java does, so allowing `println` simplifies the process – [MadProgrammer](#) Feb 27, 2015 at 6:15

@shikjohari kindly read the question properly as it's about difference and not about which one is better and I had gone through your mentioned before posting this question. – [Bhargav Modi](#) Feb 27, 2015 at 6:20

@BhargavModi Well if you go through the answer of that question, you ll understand why I said this as a duplicate. Read the asnwers also properly :) – [shikjohari](#) Feb 27, 2015 at 6:26

1 Answer

Sorted by: Highest score (default)



9



`System.out.println();` is efficient for simply printing a line of text. If the line of text needs to be formatted (ex: alignment (left-justified, etc.), etc.), then `System.out.printf();` would be used.

Check out [this link](#) for more information.

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answered Feb 27, 2015 at 6:15



**Ryan Shukis**

345 ● 1 ● 10